UNIT 9

Complements and reported content

A clause can state what someone knows, report what someone says, or ask a question within another sentence. An infinitive can also describe an action that someone commands or observes. This unit distinguishes those constructions and adds the vocabulary of occupations used in Cook II.9–12.

The examples and “The fisherman and his companion” are new teaching material. “The Choice of Occupations” is an exact source dialogue with its own help and original notes.

In the tables, 1, 2 and 3 mean first, second and third person. Singular and plural cells are shown even when their spellings coincide. Dual subjects take plural finite forms. Noun and adjective tables give nominative, genitive, dative and accusative. Forms labelled **reference** are for recognition. Keep the written vowel lengths and the distinction between e and ę.

1. Finite content clauses

A **content clause** states the content of knowing or saying. After the selected uses of **witan**, “know”, and **sęcgan**, “say, tell”, it may begin with invariant **ðæt**, “that”. The clause has its own subject and finite verb.

This conjunction has no case, gender or number. Distinguish it from the inflected **ðæt** used as a demonstrative or article and from relative **ðæt**. A relative form has a function inside its clause; the content conjunction introduces the clause without being its subject or object.

Ic wāt, ðæt se fisc gōd is.

I know that the fish is good.

The speaker presents the fish’s quality as a fact. Se fisc is the subject of is; the whole ðæt clause gives what the speaker knows.

Reported content commonly takes the subjunctive. The narrator presents someone else’s assertion without separately asserting its truth. The subjunctive does not mean that the assertion is false. Indicative content clauses remain possible when the proposition is presented as fact; an exercise that requires a particular mood will state the intended setting.

Hē sægð, ðæt se fisc gōd sīe.

He says that the fish is good.

Sægð reports the present statement; sīe is present subjunctive. English commonly uses “is” in both this translation and the preceding one.

Hē sægde, ðæt se fisc gōd wǣre.

He said that the fish was good.

Sægde places the speech in the past. Wǣre is preterite subjunctive: here the fish’s quality belongs to the time of that past speech.

Identify who each pronoun denotes when converting direct speech into a report. The original speaker’s “I” may become “he” if another person reports the words; it need not change if the same person is still speaking. Choose person and tense from the actual setting. The present and past examples above give a useful contrast for simultaneous reported content, not an automatic rule that every tense moves backward after a past verb.

The finite verb often comes later, sometimes finally, in a dependent clause. The examples use that common order. Case endings and context remain decisive when a source uses another arrangement.

2. Dependent questions

A **dependent question** gives the question whose answer someone knows or requests. It can follow **witan** or **sęcgan**. A question word such as **hwā**, **hwæt** or **hwǣm** introduces it.

Choose the question word’s case from its function within the dependent clause: nominative subject, accusative object, dative recipient or other governed complement, and genitive possessor. Its case does not come from the verb of the main clause. A verb such as helpan still requires its dative complement inside a dependent question.

Ic wāt, hwæt ðū hæbbe.

I know what you have.

Hwæt is the accusative object of hæbbe. Ðū is the subject, so the verb is second-person singular subjunctive even though its spelling matches other singular subjunctive forms.

Invariant **hwæðer**, “whether”, introduces a dependent yes/no question. It differs from the earlier inflected adjective **hwæðer**, “which of two?”. The conjunction does not agree with a following noun.

With **sęcgan**, the person addressed is dative. **Saga mē**, “tell me”, can introduce a question about what happened or whether something is so. This dative addressee differs from the accusative actor in the command construction below.

Saga mē, hwæðer ðā męnn gearwe sīen.

Tell me whether the men are ready.

Mē names the person to be told. Hwæðer introduces the whole question; ðā męnn is the plural subject of sīen.

Subjunctive is a normal pattern in dependent questions, and is the selected form when the exercises request it. An indicative may be appropriate when the dependent question concerns an asserted fact. The distinction between a dependent question and an ordinary relative clause is one of meaning and construction, not merely the position of a verb.

3. Infinitive complements and object predicates

Commands and their actors

Hātan, “command”, takes an **accusative actor + plain infinitive**. The actor is the person or thing commanded to perform the infinitive’s action. The infinitive has no person ending and no preceding tō. Its own object retains the case required by its verb.

Se mann hēt hine ðone fisc beran.

The man ordered him to carry the fish.

Se mann is the subject of hēt. Hine is the commanded actor of beran; ðone fisc is the object carried. Two accusatives need not have the same function.

Ic wille ðone fisc beran.

I want to carry the fish.

Here ic is both the subject of wille and the understood actor of beran. The earlier same-subject modal pattern does not need a separate accusative actor.

The same finite form of hātan can also mean “call, name”. Compare the complement that follows it. **Cyning** means “king”; its complete noun pattern is given below.

Hē hēt ðone mann cyning.

He called the man king.

Cyning is an accusative noun predicate identifying ðone mann. This is the naming construction from Unit 7.

Hē hēt ðone mann gān.

He ordered the man to go.

Gān is a plain infinitive; ðone mann is its commanded actor. The infinitive marks the command construction.

Perceived actions

Gesēon, "see", can take an **accusative actor + plain infinitive** describing the action perceived. The construction says that the observer sees the actor performing that action.

Ic gesēo ðone mann ðone fisc beran.

I see the man carrying the fish.

Ðone mann is the actor of beran; ðone fisc is its object. English "carrying" translates the Old English infinitive here. It does not make beran a participle.

A quality predicated of the object

With **gewyrcean**, "make", an accusative object may be followed by an adjective predicated of that object. The adjective agrees with the object in case, gender and number. It is strong in this predicate use; an article belonging to the object noun does not make the separate predicate adjective weak.

God geworhte ðone mann gōdne.

God made the man good.

Gōdne is masculine accusative singular because it describes ðone mann. Its form is not controlled by nominative God.

4. Wishes, preference and related expressions

The preterite subjunctive can express an unreal wish about the present. The past form need not refer to past time. In such a wish, **wǣre** means "were" in "would that I were", and **hæfde** can mean "had" in "would that I had". The verb commonly stands first.

Wǣre ic cyning!

Would that I were king!

The speaker is not king now. This is an unreal present wish, not a statement about a former reign.

Some indicative and subjunctive forms are identical. In particular, first-person singular hæfde can state actual past possession or express an unreal wish. The construction and the stated situation distinguish them; its spelling alone cannot.

The earlier present-subjunctive wishes and exhortations remain available, including first-person plural "let us …" and third-person "let …". These do not require the English verb "let" to be translated by an additional Old English verb.

Ne + willan can express unwillingness or refusal: "does not wish to", "will not". Use the familiar positive forms of willan with ne before the finite verb. Here English "will not" can concern someone's willingness; it need not predict the future. No new contracted negative forms are needed in these exercises.

The preference expression **ūs is lēofre wician …**, "it is preferable to us to sojourn …", has a dative experiencer, **ūs**, and the neuter comparative **lēofre**. The infinitive names what is preferable. **Wician** means "sojourn, lodge". English "we had rather" can express this present preference; its word "had" does not require a past verb.

Mid + dative names an accompanying person or cargo. In the preference construction, compare parallel mid phrases on either side of **ðonne**, "than": staying with one person is compared with staying with another. Use the dative after each mid. The accompaniment use also covers going aboard with one's wares.

In the expression "be what you ought to be", **ðæt ðe** means "what, that which", without an expressed noun antecedent. The expression identifies a role or condition and functions as a predicate with "be". It is distinct from the statement conjunction ðæt.

The familiar **sculan + plain infinitive** expresses obligation, including "ought to be". Keep the person and number of sculan appropriate to its subject. This unit uses the predicative ðæt ðe expression in those be/ought-to-be clauses.

A personal genitive can identify the group from which a member is selected: **hwilc ēower**, "which of you", and **sume hiera**, "some of them". Here **ēower**

is the genitive plural personal pronoun, not an agreeing possessive adjective. The word selecting from the group still has the case required by its own clause.

Cook also gives **hīe sume**, “some of them”. In this expression hīe and sume are both nominative plural, standing in apposition. Do not parse hīe as genitive. The appositional expression and the genitive construction are two ways to express the selection; Cook’s reference to §151 asks for the former.

5. Nouns: complete patterns and vocabulary

Each noun is given with its gender. The tables show complete singular and plural patterns. In the vocabulary tables, **stem** means the base to which the model’s endings are added. Use the headword itself for nominative singular. In the strong masculine and neuter models below, accusative singular is also unchanged; weak masculine and feminine nouns instead follow their model’s -an. The listed genitive singular and nominative plural verify the stem and principal endings.

Each vocabulary group names its full model. Replace that model’s stem by the listed stem, retaining its endings. Do not remove an internal vowel or change a root vowel unless the diagnostic forms show the change. The three new patterns—sunu, rīce and geðeahtend—are given separately in full.

In meanings marked **singular**, use the noun in that stated material, abstract or collective sense in the singular. Plural counterparts remain reference forms; they do not automatically mean kinds, portions or separate instances. Meanings marked **plural** use the plural, with singular counterparts for reference. Unmarked nouns are used in both numbers.

Strong masculines

The regular masculine has genitive singular -es and dative -e. Its plural has -as, -a, -um, -as. Cræft keeps æ before its consonant cluster; do not substitute a in its plural.

smið

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	smið	smiðas
Genitive	smiðes	smiða
Dative	smiðe	smiðum
Accusative	smið	smiðas

Vocabulary following **smið**:

Noun	Gender; meaning	Stem	Genitive singular	Nominative plural
sulhscear	m.; plowshare	sulhscear-	sulhsceares	sulhscearas
smið	m.; blacksmith	smið-	smiðes	smiðas
bęlg	m.; bellows (plural)	bęlg-	bęlges	bęlgas
ierðling	m.; farmer; plowman	ierðling-	ierðlinges	ierðlingas
mæsseprēost	m.; priest	mæsseprēost-	mæsseprēostes	mæsseprēostas
cræft	m.; trade; occupation; craft	cræft-	cræftes	cræftas
ðēowdōm	m.; service (singular)	ðēowdōm-	ðēowdōmes	ðēowdōmas
elp	m.; elephant	elp-	elpes	elpas
cyning	m.; king	cyning-	cyninges	cyningas
munuc	m.; monk	munuc-	munuces	munucas
dręnc	m.; drink (singular)	dręnc-	dręnces	dręncas
ceorl	m.; layman	ceorl-	ceorles	ceorlas
pliht	m.; peril; risk	pliht-	plihtes	plihtas
beorn	m.; warrior	beorn-	beornes	beornas

Masculines in -e

The headword's final -e remains in nominative and accusative singular. Before another ending use the listed stem: fiscer- + -es gives fisceres. Dative singular ends in -e; the plural has the ordinary masculine endings.

fiscere

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	fiscere	fisceras
Genitive	fisceres	fiscera
Dative	fiscere	fiscerum
Accusative	fiscere	fisceras

Vocabulary following **fiscere**:

Noun	Gender; meaning	Stem	Genitive singular	Nominative plural
mangere	m.; merchant	manger-	mangeres	mangeras
ęle	m.; oil (singular)	ęl-	ęles	ęlas
fiscere	m.; fisherman	fiscer-	fisceres	fisceras
sēamere	m.; tailor	sēamer-	sēameres	sēameras
ealdorscipe	m.; chief place; primacy (singular)	ealdorscip-	ealdorscipes	ealdorscipas
lyre	m.; loss (singular)	lyr-	lyres	lyras

A masculine with a shortened stem

Angel loses its internal e before endings: use angl-. The headword remains angel in nominative and accusative singular.

angel

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	angel	anglas
Genitive	angles	angla
Dative	angle	anglum
Accusative	angel	anglas

Vocabulary following **angel**:

Noun	Gender; meaning	Stem	Genitive singular	Nominative plural
angel	m.; fish-hook	angl-	angles	anglas

Strong neuters with an endingless plural

These neuters have the usual -es and -e in genitive and dative singular. Nominative and accusative plural have no ending; genitive and dative plural have -a and -um.

hūs

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	hūs	hūs
Genitive	hūses	hūsa
Dative	hūse	hūsum
Accusative	hūs	hūs

Vocabulary following **hūs**:

Noun	Gender; meaning	Stem	Genitive singular	Nominative plural
hūs	n.; house	hūs-	hūses	hūs
wīn	n.; wine (singular)	wīn-	wīnes	wīn
gold	n.; gold (singular)	gold-	goldes	gold
hors	n.; horse	hors-	horses	hors
godspell	n.; Gospel (singular)	godspell-	godspelles	godspell
gestrēon	n.; gain; profit (singular)	gestrēon-	gestrēones	gestrēon
gedeorf	n.; labor; toil (singular)	gedeorf-	gedeorfes	gedeorf
bān	n.; bone	bān-	bānes	bān
folc	n.; people, as a collective (singular)	folc-	folces	folc
geflīt	n.; dispute; strife	geflīt-	geflītes	geflīt
wīf	n.; wife	wīf-	wīfes	wīf
hlæst	n.; wares; merchandise; cargo (plural)	hlæst-	hlæstes	hlæst
ǣr	n.; copper (singular)	ǣr-	ǣres	ǣr

Short-stem neuters

The short stem takes -u in nominative and accusative plural. Tin has a short vowel. In this unit the material “tin” is used in the singular; its plural table is a reference model.

tin

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	tin	tinu
Genitive	tines	tina
Dative	tine	tinum
Accusative	tin	tinu

Vocabulary following **tin**:

Noun	Gender; meaning	Stem	Genitive singular	Nominative plural
tin	n.; tin (singular)	tin-	tines	tinu

A neuter retaining its internal vowel

Ðyrel has short y and retains its internal e before endings. Its nominative and accusative plural end in -u.

ðyrel

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	ðyrel	ðyrelu
Genitive	ðyreles	ðyrela
Dative	ðyrele	ðyrelum
Accusative	ðyrel	ðyrelu

Vocabulary following **ðyrel**:

Noun	Gender; meaning	Stem	Genitive singular	Nominative plural
ðyrel	n.; hole	ðyrel-	ðyreles	ðyrelu

A neuter with a shortened stem

Fōdor uses fōdr- before endings. Its ordinary sense here is singular "fodder"; the plural counterparts are reference forms.

fōdor

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	fōdor	fōdru
Genitive	fōdres	fōdra
Dative	fōdre	fōdrum
Accusative	fōdor	fōdru

Vocabulary following **fōdor**:

Noun	Gender; meaning	Stem	Genitive singular	Nominative plural
fōdor	n.; fodder (singular)	fōdr-	fōdres	fōdru

Strong feminines

The nominative singular is the headword. The other singular cases end in -e; the selected plural has -a, -a, -um, -a. Feminine nominative and accusative plural -e is a documented alternative to selected -a. Both æl “awl” and slęcg “hammer” are feminine.

nǣdl

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	nǣdl	nǣdla
Genitive	nǣdle	nǣdla
Dative	nǣdle	nǣdlum
Accusative	nǣdle	nǣdla

Vocabulary following **nǣdl**:

Noun	Gender; meaning	Stem	Genitive singular	Nominative plural
nǣdl	f.; needle	nǣdl-	nǣdle	nǣdla
æl	f.; awl	æl-	æle	æla
slęcg	f.; hammer	slęcg-	slęcge	slęcga
eorðtilð	f.; agriculture (singular)	eorðtilð-	eorðtilðe	eorðtilða

Feminines in -nes

Keep the single s of the headword in nominative singular, but use the stem in -ness- before every ending. These nouns take the same case endings as nǣdl.

forlidennes

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	forlidennes	forlidennessa
Genitive	forlidennesse	forlidennessa
Dative	forlidennesse	forlidennessum
Accusative	forlidennesse	forlidennessa

Vocabulary following **forlidennes**:

Noun	Gender; meaning	Stem	Genitive singular	Nominative plural
forlidennes	f.; shipwreck	forlidenness-	forlidennesse	forlidennessa
rihtwīsnes	f.; righteousness (singular)	rihtwīsness-	rihtwīsnesse	rihtwīsnessa

Weak masculines

Weak masculine nominative singular ends in -a. The other singular cases and nominative and accusative plural end in -an; genitive plural has -ena, dative plural -um.

fȳrspearca

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	fȳrspearca	fȳrspearcan
Genitive	fȳrspearcan	fȳrspearcena
Dative	fȳrspearcan	fȳrspearcum
Accusative	fȳrspearcan	fȳrspearcan

Vocabulary following **fȳrspearca**:

Noun	Gender; meaning	Stem	Genitive singular	Nominative plural
fȳrspearca	m.; spark	fȳrspearc-	fȳrspearcan	fȳrspearcan
trēowwyrhta	m.; carpenter	trēowwyrht-	trēowwyrhtan	trēowwyrhtan
scēowyrhta	m.; shoemaker	scēowyrht-	scēowyrhtan	scēowyrhtan
cęmpa	m.; soldier	cęmp-	cęmpan	cęmpan
wyrhta	m.; workman; craftsman	wyrht-	wyrhtan	wyrhtan

Weak feminines

Weak feminine nominative singular ends in -e. The other seven cells use the same endings as the weak masculine pattern. Smiððe and sīde follow this pattern.

smiððe

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	smiððe	smiððan
Genitive	smiððan	smiððena
Dative	smiððan	smiððum
Accusative	smiððan	smiððan

Vocabulary following **smiððe**:

Noun	Gender; meaning	Stem	Genitive singular	Nominative plural
smiððe	f.; smithy	smiðð-	smiððan	smiððan
sīde	f.; silk (singular)	sīd-	sīdan	sīdan

A compound of mann

The final member follows mann: dative singular and nominative/accusative plural have ealdormęnn. The other forms retain ealdormann-.

ealdormann

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	ealdormann	ealdormęnn
Genitive	ealdormannes	ealdormanna
Dative	ealdormęnn	ealdormannum
Accusative	ealdormann	ealdormęnn

Vocabulary following **ealdormann**:

Noun	Gender; meaning	Stem	Genitive singular	Nominative plural
ealdormann	m.; prince; leader; noble	ealdormann-	ealdormannes	ealdormęnn

Sunu: the u-stem pattern

Sunu has short u. Nominative and accusative singular end in -u; genitive and dative singular in -a. The plural has -a except in the dative, which has -um. Cook also records -u/-o variants outside the genitives and dative plural, and later forms sunes/sunas following the ordinary masculine pattern. The table gives the selected pattern.

sunu

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	sunu	suna
Genitive	suna	suna
Dative	suna	sunum
Accusative	sunu	suna

Vocabulary following **sunu**:

Noun	Gender; meaning	Stem	Genitive singular	Nominative plural
sunu	m.; son	sun-	suna	suna

Rīce: a neuter in -e

The final -e remains in the singular where no other ending replaces it. Use rīc- before plural endings: rīcu, rīca, rīcum. Cook also gives forms with inserted i/e after c or g; rīciu and rīcia are documented alternatives to selected rīcu and rīca.

rīce

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	rīce	rīcu
Genitive	rīces	rīca
Dative	rīce	rīcum
Accusative	rīce	rīcu

Vocabulary following **rīce**:

Noun	Gender; meaning	Stem	Genitive singular	Nominative plural
rīce	n.; kingdom	rīc-	rīces	rīcu

Geðeahtend: an agent noun in -end

Geðeahtend names a person, a counsellor. Its selected nominative and accusative plural have no ending; genitive plural has -ra and dative plural -um. Plural nominative/accusative -e and the rarer -as also occur. This noun pattern is distinct from the adjective inflection of a present participle in -ende.

geðeahtend

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	geðeahtend	geðeahtend
Genitive	geðeahtendes	geðeahtendra
Dative	geðeahtende	geðeahtendum
Accusative	geðeahtend	geðeahtend

Vocabulary following **geðeahtend**:

Noun	Gender; meaning	Stem	Genitive singular	Nominative plural
geðeahtend	m.; counsellor	geðeahtend-	geðeahtendes	geðeahtend

Distinguish **beorn**, “warrior”, from **cęmpa**, “soldier”. **Mæsseprēost** is the selected word for “priest”; **ceorl** here means “layman”. **Hlæst** is used as plural “wares”. The selected use of **bęlg** refers to plural bellows/bags; choose verb agreement from the Old English number rather than from the shape of the English word “bellows”.

6. Adjectives and agreement

The complete strong and weak forms follow. Use strong adjectives in ordinary predication or unmarked attribution, weak adjectives after the article/demonstrative and in direct address. Comparatives are weak. The tables preserve the selected feminine plural -a; the familiar -e alternative is also valid.

The distinct instrumental is not added to these four-case practice patterns.

behēfe — useful

Use behēf- before endings. As an adjective in -e, behēfe retains that e only where another ending does not replace it. The selected strong feminine nominative singular and neuter nominative/accusative plural are behēfu.

behēfe: strong declension, singular

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	behēfe	behēfe	behēfu
Genitive	behēfes	behēfes	behēfre
Dative	behēfum	behēfum	behēfre
Accusative	behēfne	behēfe	behēfe

behēfe: strong declension, plural

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	behēfe	behēfu	behēfa
Genitive	behēfra	behēfra	behēfra
Dative	behēfum	behēfum	behēfum
Accusative	behēfe	behēfu	behēfa

behēfe: weak declension, singular

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	behēfa	behēfe	behēfe
Genitive	behēfan	behēfan	behēfan
Dative	behēfan	behēfan	behēfan
Accusative	behēfan	behēfe	behēfan

behēfe: weak declension, plural

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	behēfan	behēfan	behēfan
Genitive	behēfra	behēfra	behēfra
Dative	behēfum	behēfum	behēfum
Accusative	behēfan	behēfan	behēfan

welig — rich; wealthy

Keep the stem welig- in these selected forms, including the medial i. Strong feminine nominative singular and neuter nominative/accusative plural have -u: weligu.

welig: strong declension, singular

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	welig	welig	weligu
Genitive	weliges	weliges	weligre
Dative	weligum	weligum	weligre
Accusative	weligne	welig	welige

welig: strong declension, plural

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	welige	weligu	weliga
Genitive	weligra	weligra	weligra
Dative	weligum	weligum	weligum
Accusative	welige	weligu	weliga

welig: weak declension, singular

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	weliga	welige	welige
Genitive	weligan	weligan	weligan
Dative	weligan	weligan	weligan
Accusative	weligan	welige	weligan

welig: weak declension, plural

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	weligan	weligan	weligan
Genitive	weligra	weligra	weligra
Dative	weligum	weligum	weligum
Accusative	weligan	weligan	weligan

wīs — wise

The heavy stem wīs- has no -u in strong feminine nominative singular or neuter nominative/accusative plural.

wīs: strong declension, singular

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	wīs	wīs	wīs
Genitive	wīses	wīses	wīsre
Dative	wīsum	wīsum	wīsre
Accusative	wīsne	wīs	wīse

wīs: strong declension, plural

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	wīse	wīs	wīsa
Genitive	wīsra	wīsra	wīsra
Dative	wīsum	wīsum	wīsum
Accusative	wīse	wīs	wīsa

wīs: weak declension, singular

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	wīsa	wīse	wīse
Genitive	wīsan	wīsan	wīsan
Dative	wīsan	wīsan	wīsan
Accusative	wīsan	wīse	wīsan

wīs: weak declension, plural

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	wīsan	wīsan	wīsan
Genitive	wīsra	wīsra	wīsra
Dative	wīsum	wīsum	wīsum
Accusative	wīsan	wīsan	wīsan

manig — many

Use manig as an ordinary attributive adjective with a plural noun. The singular tables below are reference only; they do not add “many a” or a new substantival use. Keep manig- in the selected forms; neuter nominative/accusative plural is manigu.

manig: strong declension, singular

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	manig	manig	manigu
Genitive	maniges	maniges	manigre
Dative	manigum	manigum	manigre
Accusative	manigne	manig	manige

manig: strong declension, plural

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	manige	manigu	maniga
Genitive	manigra	manigra	manigra
Dative	manigum	manigum	manigum
Accusative	manige	manigu	maniga

manig: weak declension, singular

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	maniga	manige	manige
Genitive	manigan	manigan	manigan
Dative	manigan	manigan	manigan
Accusative	manigan	manige	manigan

manig: weak declension, plural

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	manigan	manigan	manigan
Genitive	manigra	manigra	manigra
Dative	manigum	manigum	manigum
Accusative	manigan	manigan	manigan

wīsra — wiser

Add the comparative r to wīs-, without changing the vowel, and use weak endings. Genitive plural wīsra simplifies doubled r after s; do not build wīsrra mechanically. This is the same type of reduction seen in earlier lēofra.

wīsra: weak declension, singular

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	wīsra	wīsre	wīsre
Genitive	wīsran	wīsran	wīsran
Dative	wīsran	wīsran	wīsran
Accusative	wīsran	wīsre	wīsran

wīsra: weak declension, plural

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nominative	wīsran	wīsran	wīsran
Genitive	wīsra	wīsra	wīsra
Dative	wīsrum	wīsrum	wīsrum
Accusative	wīsran	wīsran	wīsran

Behēfe, “useful”, can name the person to whom something is useful in the dative. The adjective itself agrees with the subject; the recipient remains dative regardless of that subject’s gender.

A predicate adjective referring jointly to nouns of different grammatical genders normally takes the neuter plural. Thus the combination of masculine **ęle** and neuter **wīn** calls for the selected neuter plural **gōd**. The zero ending does not make gōd singular in that use.

In direct address, use the noun’s nominative form and a weak accompanying adjective. The number still matters: address one person with singular forms, more than one with plural forms. **Ēalā**, “O”, is an invariant interjection that may introduce an address or an exclamation.

7. Verbs: complete finite forms

Each indicative table gives all three persons in both numbers, in the present and preterite. Plural persons share a form, but still refer to different subjects. Each table includes the verb’s stem changes as well as its endings.

The infinitives heading these tables name the verbs. This unit adds their finite forms; the new infinitive used in a sentence is **wician** in the preference construction. Earlier productive infinitives such as beran, gān and tēon remain available in the constructions already explained.

Weak I

cīepan — sell

Weak I. The object sold is accusative. The preterite has -pte after p: cīepte.

cīepan: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	cīepe	cīepte
2 singular	cīepst	cīeptest
3 singular	cīepð	cīepte
1 plural	cīepað	cīepton
2 plural	cīepað	cīepton
3 plural	cīepað	cīepton

āfēdan — feed; support

Weak I. The person supported is accusative. Final d and the third-singular dental ending yield tt in āfētt. The preterite keeps -dde: āfēdde.

āfēdan: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	āfēde	āfēdde
2 singular	āfētst	āfēddest
3 singular	āfētt	āfēdde
1 plural	āfēdað	āfēddon
2 plural	āfēdað	āfēddon
3 plural	āfēdað	āfēddon

bycgan — buy

Weak I with an exceptional preterite. The goods bought are accusative. Keep bycg- in bycge/bycgað, but single g in bygest/bygeð. The preterite has bohte and bohton; do not form a regular preterite from bycg-.

bycgan: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	bycge	bohte
2 singular	bygest	bohtest
3 singular	bygeð	bohte
1 plural	bycgað	bohton
2 plural	bycgað	bohton
3 plural	bycgað	bohton

sēcan — seek

Weak I with preterite sōhte/sōhton. The thing sought is accusative. The present and preterite stems also supply the complete subjunctive below.

sēcan: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	sēce	sōhte
2 singular	sēcst	sōhtest
3 singular	sēcð	sōhte
1 plural	sēcað	sōhton
2 plural	sēcað	sōhton
3 plural	sēcað	sōhton

gestillan — settle; quell

Weak I. The disturbance or dispute quelled is accusative. The doubled l is reduced before the preterite dental ending: gestilde.

gestillan: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	gestille	gestilde
2 singular	gestilst	gestildest
3 singular	gestilð	gestilde
1 plural	gestillað	gestildon
2 plural	gestillað	gestildon
3 plural	gestillað	gestildon

fręmman — benefit

Weak I. Keep doubled mm in fręmme/fręmmað; the second and third singular have fręmest/fręmeð, and the preterite has fręmede. The person benefited is dative.

fręmman: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	fręmme	fręmede
2 singular	fręmest	fręmedest
3 singular	fręmeð	fręmede
1 plural	fręmmað	fręmedon
2 plural	fręmmað	fręmedon
3 plural	fręmmað	fręmedon

ālīehtan — illuminate; give light to

Weak I. The thing illuminated is accusative. The selected second and third singular forms are uncontracted ālīehtest/ālīehteð. The preterite is ālīehte: the dental ending joins the stem's ht without adding another t. Present first singular and preterite first/third singular therefore coincide; present and preterite second singular also coincide.

ālīehtan: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	ālīehte	ālīehte
2 singular	ālīehtest	ālīehtest
3 singular	ālīehteð	ālīehte
1 plural	ālīehtað	ālīehton
2 plural	ālīehtað	ālīehton
3 plural	ālīehtað	ālīehton

rǣdan — read

The selected preterite is weak: rǣdde/rǣddon. Present third singular rǣtt shows the joining of the stem dental and ending. Rǣdan can take an accusative text or stand without an expressed object, "read". Strong preterites rēd/rēdon are documented alternatives, for recognition rather than an additional system to recall here.

rǣdan: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	rǣde	rǣdde
2 singular	rǣtst	rǣddest
3 singular	rǣtt	rǣdde
1 plural	rǣdað	rǣddon
2 plural	rǣdað	rǣddon
3 plural	rǣdað	rǣddon

Weak II

wician — sojourn; lodge

Weak II. The present has -ie, -ast, -að and plural -iað; the preterite has -ode/-odest/-odon. Use mid + dative for the person with whom one lodges. The plain infinitive wician is also used in the preference expression.

wician: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	wicie	wicode
2 singular	wicast	wicodest
3 singular	wicað	wicode
1 plural	wiciað	wicodon
2 plural	wiciað	wicodon
3 plural	wiciað	wicodon

ðolian — suffer

Weak II, with the same endings as wician. The hardship or loss suffered is accusative.

ðolian: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	ðolie	ðolode
2 singular	ðolast	ðolodest
3 singular	ðolað	ðolode
1 plural	ðoliað	ðolodon
2 plural	ðoliað	ðolodon
3 plural	ðoliað	ðolodon

gegaderian — gather

Weak II. The thing or things gathered are accusative. Keep the prefix ge- throughout the selected forms.

gegaderian: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	gegaderie	gegaderode
2 singular	gegaderast	gegaderodest
3 singular	gegaderað	gegaderode
1 plural	gegaderiað	gegaderodon
2 plural	gegaderiað	gegaderodon
3 plural	gegaderiað	gegaderodon

Strong verbs

rōwan — row

Strong. The second and third singular present change ō to ē: rēwst/rēwð. The preterite has rēow-. The verb can stand without an object; ofer introduces an expressed route across something.

rōwan: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	rōwe	rēow
2 singular	rēwst	rēowe
3 singular	rēwð	rēow
1 plural	rōwað	rēowon
2 plural	rōwað	rēowon
3 plural	rōwað	rēowon

blāwan — blow

Strong. The second and third singular present have ǣ; the preterite has blēow-. In the bellows sentence the verb stands without an expressed object.

blāwan: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	blāwe	blēow
2 singular	blǣwst	blēowe
3 singular	blǣwð	blēow
1 plural	blāwað	blēowon
2 plural	blāwað	blēowon
3 plural	blāwað	blēowon

forlǣtan — abandon; leave

Strong. The person or thing abandoned is accusative. The preterite stem is forlēt-. Present third singular forlǣtt joins the stem t and dental ending.

forlǣtan: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	forlǣte	forlēt
2 singular	forlǣtst	forlēte
3 singular	forlǣtt	forlēt
1 plural	forlǣtað	forlēton
2 plural	forlǣtað	forlēton
3 plural	forlǣtað	forlēton

āstīgan — go aboard; board

Strong I. Present g becomes h before st/ð: āstīhst/āstīhð. The selected preterite singular is āstāg, second singular āstige, plural āstigon. Final āstāh is a documented alternative to āstāg. The ship boarded is a direct accusative object.

āstīgan: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	āstīge	āstāg
2 singular	āstīhst	āstige
3 singular	āstīhð	āstāg
1 plural	āstīgað	āstigon
2 plural	āstīgað	āstigon
3 plural	āstīgað	āstigon

bēatan — beat

Strong. The person or thing beaten is accusative. Present second and third singular change ēa to īe; bīett joins the stem dental and ending. The preterite has bēot-.

bēatan: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	bēate	bēot
2 singular	bīetst	bēote
3 singular	bīett	bēot
1 plural	bēatað	bēoton
2 plural	bēatað	bēoton
3 plural	bēatað	bēoton

The prefixed gān pattern

begān — ply; practise

Begān follows the earlier gān pattern with a prefix. The occupation practised is accusative. Keep begǣst/begǣð in the present and beēode/beēodest/beēodon in the preterite; the prefix does not turn the verb into a weak verb.

begān: complete indicative

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	begā	beēode
2 singular	begǣst	beēodest
3 singular	begǣð	beēode
1 plural	begāð	beēodon
2 plural	begāð	beēodon
3 plural	begāð	beēodon

Commands

The singular command addresses one person; the plural command addresses more than one. The tables give both forms of these six verbs. Their plural commands have the same spelling as the present indicative plurals, but their use in an instruction is different. The singular commands rōw, byge, sēc, begā, gestil and rǣd are shown with their plural counterparts.

rōwan: both commands

Person and number	Command
Second singular	rōw
Second plural	rōwað

bycgan: both commands

Person and number	Command
Second singular	byge
Second plural	bycgað

sēcan: both commands

Person and number	Command
Second singular	sēc
Second plural	sēcað

begān: both commands

Person and number	Command
Second singular	begā
Second plural	begāð

gestillan: both commands

Person and number	Command
Second singular	gestil
Second plural	gestillað

rædan: both commands

Person and number	Command
Second singular	ræd
Second plural	rædað

Sēcan: subjunctive

The present subjunctive uses sēc-, the preterite sōht-. Each has singular -e and plural -en for all three persons. Use the present first-person plural in a "let us seek" exhortation. These forms can also be used in the subjunctive constructions explained above.

sēcan: complete subjunctive

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 singular	sēce	sōhte
2 singular	sēce	sōhte
3 singular	sēce	sōhte
1 plural	sēcen	sōhten
2 plural	sēcen	sōhten
3 plural	sēcen	sōhten

8. Further uses and small words

Slēan, “strike, smite”, can stand without naming an object when it means “make a stroke”. Its earlier use with an accusative object remains available; the absence of an object here does not require a new conjugation.

Use **tēon … forð**, “bring forth, produce”, with an accusative thing produced. **Forð** is an invariant adverb. The familiar plain infinitive tēon can follow commanding hātan; the present subjunctive can express a wish or exhortation. Keep the actor of the action distinct from what it produces.

On + accusative places an event on a numbered day. The article and ordinal agree with the accusative day noun. This time expression differs from ordinary **on + dative** locating something in a place.

For-ðām, “because”, introduces a factual reason; use the indicative in the reason clause. **Hwīlum**, “sometimes”, is an invariant adverb of frequency. Its ending does not require you to supply a noun case construction.

Godes ðēowdōm means “service of God”: God is the one served. A genitive relationship need not be simple ownership. This expression uses the new service sense of ðēowdōm.

9. Practice in forms and constructions

All exercises labelled with a letter are new teaching material. Preserve vowel length and the selected forms in recall tasks. In translation, preserve the stated meaning and requested construction. When a task specifies a mood, a grammatically possible sentence using another mood may still fail that particular target.

Forms and case use

F01.
Give the nominative, genitive, dative and accusative singular and plural of sunu. Distinguish the dative singular from the nominative and accusative singular.

F02.
Give the complete present and preterite indicative of bycgan. Name all three persons in each number, including cells with identical spellings.

F03.
Give the singular and plural commands of rōwan and bycgan. State which forms address one person and which address more than one.

F04.
Give the nominative, genitive, dative and accusative singular and plural of rīce and geðeahtend. Identify the characteristic plural endings of each pattern.

F05.
Translate the nominative noun phrase ‘the kingdoms of the counsellors’, placing the genitive dependent first and omitting a separate article for the head noun. Then translate ‘I give the fish (sing.) to the counsellors.’ Explain the different cases of ‘counsellors’.

Content and report

A01.
Classify every ðæt in these sentences as demonstrative/article, relative, or content conjunction. For each inflected occurrence, give its case and explain whether it agrees with a noun or functions within the relative clause. (a) Ðæt scip is gōd. (b) Ic wāt, ðæt ðæt scip gōd is. (c) Ðæt scip, ðæt ðū hæfst, is gōd.

A02.
Translate: I know that the ships are empty. Present their emptiness as an asserted fact and use the indicative in the content clause.

A03.
Se fiscere cwið: “Ic hæbbe twēgen fiscas.” Report his words beginning Se fiscere sægð and using ðæt with the present subjunctive. The fisherman is the possessor in both versions.

A04.
Se mann cwæð: “Ic hæbbe twēgen fiscas.” Report the same state at the time of his past speech, beginning Se mann sægde. Use ðæt and the preterite subjunctive; the same man possessed the fish.

A05.
A task requests a subjunctive report, but a learner writes Hē sægð, ðæt hē gōd is. Is the sentence necessarily ungrammatical? Give the requested form and explain the distinction.

Dependent questions

Q01.
Translate both clauses and explain the case of the question word. (a) Ic wāt, hwā ðone fisc hæbbe. (b) Ic wāt, hwǣm ðū ðone fisc sęlle.

Q02.
Turn Hwæt hæfst ðū? into a dependent question after Saga mē. Keep the same addressee and use the present subjunctive.

Q03.
Turn Hæfð se mann twēgen fiscas? into a dependent yes/no question after Saga mē. Use hwæðer and the present subjunctive.

Q04.
Translate and distinguish the two uses of hwæðer. In (a), two men are under discussion. (a) Hwæðer mann is ðīn gefēra? (b) Saga mē, hwæðer se mann ðīn gefēra sīe.

Q05.
Translate: I know whom you (sing.) help. Use a dependent question with hwǣm and the present subjunctive.

Infinitives and object predicates

I01.
Translate both sentences and identify who carries the fish. (a) Ic wille ðone fisc beran. (b) Ic hāte hine ðone fisc beran. Explain why beran has no person ending in either sentence.

I02.
The fisherman told two companions, “Berað ðone fisc.” Report this as a past command using hātan, hīe for the companions, and a plain infinitive.

I03.
Translate: I see the men carrying the fish (sing.). Use gesēon with an accusative actor and a plain infinitive; label both accusative noun phrases.

I04.
Translate both sentences using gewyrcean followed by an object and an agreeing predicate adjective: God made the man good. God made the men good. Explain the adjective endings.

I05.
Translate and distinguish the two complements: Hē hēt ðone mann cyning. Hē hēt ðone mann gān. State the case/function of cyning and the form/function of gān.

Unreal wishes

W01.

You have no ship. Express the present unreal wish “Would that I had one ship!” using the preterite subjunctive of habban.

W02.

Translate these in their stated settings: (a) a report about last year, Ic hæfde ān scip.; (b) a wish by someone who has no ship now, Hæfde ic ān scip! Explain what the shared spelling hæfde can and cannot show.

10. The fisherman and his companion

New teaching material. Read the connected exchange, then answer the questions below.

> Se fiscere and his gefēra standað on ðǣm strande. Se gefēra cwið: “Saga mē, hwæt ðū hæbbe.” Se fiscere sægð, ðæt hē męte hæbbe. Hē hætt his gefēran ðone fisc beran. Se gefēra birð ðone fisc. Se fiscere cwið: “Ic gesēo ðē ðone fisc beran. Nū wāt ic, ðæt ðū mē hilpst.”

Reading practice

R01.

In the controlled reading, who requests information, and who is reported to have food? Answer in English and cite the two relevant clauses.

R02.

In the controlled reading, compare hwæt ðū hæbbe, ðæt hē męte hæbbe, and ðæt ðū mē hilpst. Identify each clause type and explain the selected moods.

R03.

Identify the commanded actor in Hē hætt his gefēran ðone fisc beran and the observed actor in Ic gesēo ðē ðone fisc beran. For each sentence, distinguish that actor from the fish and identify the finite verb.

R04.

Translate the complete controlled reading, preserving the speakers, the command, the carrying action and the final distinction between report and asserted knowledge.

11. The Choice of Occupations

Exact source text from Cook's *A First Book in Old English*. The Teacher asks the Counsellor to rank occupations. Several expressions are supplied in the local helps for reading; their unfamiliar forms are not required for independent composition.

Teacher. Hwæt sægst ðū, wīsa? Hwilc cræft ðē is geðūht betweox ðās furðra wesan?

Counsellor. Ic sęcge ðē, mē is geðūht Godes ðēowdōm betweoh ðās cræftas ealdorscipe healdan, swā-swā hit is gerǣd on godspelle, "Fyrmest sēceað rīce Godes, and rihtwīsnesse his, and ðās ðing eall bēoð tōgēiecte ēow."

Teacher. And hwilc ðē is geðūht betweox woruldcræftas healdan ealdordōm?

Counsellor. Eorðtilð, for-ðām se ierðling ūs ealle fēt.

Local help

1. wīsa. "Wise man; wise one", in direct address. It is the weak masculine singular of wīs used as a noun. This personal use is given here for reading.

2. ðē is geðūht … wesan / mē is geðūht … healdan. "To you it seems … to be / to me it seems … to hold." Read these as complete expressions. The person to whom it seems is dative. Cook identifies furðra as nominative singular; these source expressions do not follow one uniform accusative-actor pattern like commanding hātan.

3. betweox / betweoh ðās (cræftas). "Among these (occupations)." The two spellings mean the same thing here. The following phrase is accusative plural. In the first question, cræftas is understood after ðās.

4. furðra. "Foremost; prior." This is a weak comparative, masculine nominative singular, as Cook's note 14 states. This one form and sense are given for the passage.

5. swā-swā hit is gerǣd on godspelle. "Just as it is read in the Gospel." Swā-swā means "just as"; gerǣd is the past participle in this passive expression. Read the whole phrase with this help.

6. Fyrmest sēceað. "First seek", a plural command. Sēceað is the form printed in the source; recognize it beside the selected plural command sēcað.

7. ðās ðing eall bēoð tōgēiecte ēow. “All these things will be added to you.” Eall agrees with neuter plural ðing. Bēoð is third-person plural here; ēow is the dative recipient. Tōgēiecte is a predicate participle. Keep its printed -e: Cook’s §62 describes this predicate use, so it should not be silently changed to an expected neuter ending.

8. woruldcræftas / ealdordōm. “Worldly occupations” (accusative plural) / “chief place, primacy” (accusative singular). Cook prints woruldcræftas but records the manuscript words cræftas woruld in note 20.

9. ūs ealle fēt. “Feeds us all.” Ūs is accusative plural; ealle refers to the people fed and is masculine plural. Fēt is present indicative third singular of fēdan. This exact form is given for reading; the prefixed āfēdan table does not supply a complete system for fēdan.

10. the three conjectural is insertions. Cook calls the is in each Teacher question and in swā-swā hit is gerǣd conjectural: they are absent from his manuscripts. The is in mē is geðūht instead belongs to note 15. The printed text here retains Cook’s three insertions.

11. Godes ðēowdōm; rihtwīsnesse his. “God’s service, service of God”; “his righteousness”. The genitives identify the divine possessor or the one served. His follows its noun in the second phrase.

Cook’s original notes

The numbers are Cook’s original note numbers. “Lat.” identifies his Latin comparison; “MSS.” means manuscripts. His section references point to the grammar in his *First Book*.

Note	Anchor	Original note
11	cræft	Lat. ars.
12	is (three occurrences)	Conjectural; not in the MSS.
13	geðūht	See ðyncan.
14	furðra	Lat. prior. Nom. sing.
15	mē is geðūht	Lat. videtur.
16	ðēowdōm	See 143 and 149.
17	ealdorscipe; ealdordōm	Lat. primatum.
18	rihtwīsnesse	See 144.
19	tōgēiecte	Lat. adjicientur. See tōgēiecan, and 62.
20	woruldcræftas	Lat. artes seculares. MS. cræftas woruld.
21	Eorðtilð	Lat. agricultura. See 147.
22	ierðling	Lat. arator.
23	fēt	See fēdan.

Supported source practice

Use the text, vocabulary and local helps. These tasks ask you to understand the supported source; they do not require unaided recall of the unfamiliar source forms.

S01.
In the source dialogue, which occupation receives first place overall, and which receives first place among worldly occupations? Explain why the two answers do not contradict one another.

S02.
Identify the beginning and end of the Gospel quotation in the source dialogue. What does it command, and what does it promise? Use the printed helps for unfamiliar forms.

S03.
In Ic sęcge ðē, mē is geðūht, explain the different roles of ðē and mē using the local help. Who is addressed, and whose judgment follows?

S04.
What reason does the Counsellor give for agriculture's place? Explain the reference of ūs ealle in the final turn and identify the subject of fēt.

S05.
Translate all four source turns, including the complete Gospel quotation. Preserve the distinction between the overall ranking and the later question about worldly occupations.

12. Cook II.9–12

Translate the complete English prompts into Old English. Cook's numbering, parentheses, brackets and grammar references are retained. "Sing." and "plur." specify number; "om." asks you to omit the English word indicated. Section numbers refer to Cook's grammar. Use the local help printed with the three supported expressions.

In a "let us" or "let …" exhortation, use the appropriate present subjunctive unless another construction is expressly requested. Direct address uses the nominative-shaped noun and a weak accompanying adjective. In the reported-speech item, follow the prompt as printed; a content conjunction has not been silently added.

Exercise 9
Cook II.9.1.
Sparks fly.

Cook II.9.2.
The house is empty.

Cook II.9.3.
The ships are empty.

Cook II.9.4.
The merchant sells needles, awls, fish-hooks, and plowshares.

Cook II.9.5.
The blacksmith makes plowshares in his smithy.

Cook II.9.6.
The oil and the wine are good.

Cook II.9.7.
The fisherman rows over the sea.

Cook II.9.8.
The carpenter supports his son.

Cook II.9.9.
The tailor bought the needle.

Cook II.9.10.
The bellows blow.

Cook II.9.11.
The hammer smites,

Cook II.9.12.
Let us seek the kingdom of God.

Cook II.9.13.
He will not live with the blacksmith.

Cook II.9.14.
We had rather live [To us it is preferable to sojourn] with the farmer than with the tailor.

Cook II.9.15.
Gold is better (66) than tin.

Cook II.9.16.
The carpenter makes a hole.

Exercise 10

Cook II.10.1.
The tree is useful to the carpenter.

Cook II.10.2.
Our horses have fodder.

Cook II.10.3.
O priest, read the Gospel.

Cook II.10.4.
Buy (sing.) wine and oil.

Cook II.10.5.
O good fellows, row over the waters.

Cook II.10.6.
Her son is rich.

Cook II.10.7.
Ply (sing.) your trade.

Cook II.10.8.
God gave us his Gospel.

Cook II.10.9.
The farmer practises agriculture.

Cook II.10.10.
The service of God [God's service] is better (66) than other occupations.

Cook II.10.11.
Which of you holds (om. the) chief place?

Cook II.10.12.
My gain is little.

Cook II.10.13.
My labor is great.

Local help for II.10.14: elpes bān — "ivory", literally "elephant's bone". Elpes is genitive singular; bān is neuter accusative singular as the thing sold. Use this whole expression as given.

Cook II.10.14.
I sold ivory and silk.

Cook II.10.15.
O, were I king of this people!

Exercise 11

Cook II.11.1.
The monks have food and drink.

Cook II.11.2.
Settle [quell] your disputes.

Cook II.11.3.
He suffered shipwreck.

Cook II.11.4.
He abandoned his wife.

Cook II.11.5.
Be what [that] you (sing.) ought to be.

Cook II.11.6.
They do not wish to be what they ought to be.

Cook II.11.7.
He went aboard the ship with his wares.

Cook II.11.8.
O good workmen, ply your trades.

Cook II.11.9.
I tell you (sing.), the shoemaker buys awls, and the fisherman buys (fish-) hooks.

Cook II.11.10.
Sometimes he reads, because he is wise.

Cook II.11.11.
The king buys horses.

Cook II.11.12.
Righteousness is better than gold.

Cook II.11.13.
They struck me.

Cook II.11.14.
The farmer beats him.

Cook II.11.15.
We suffer the loss of copper and tin.

Cook II.11.16.
The princes of the earth go aboard their ships.

Cook II.11.17.
The priest benefits (164. e) the laymen.

Exercise 12
Cook II.12.1.
The counsellor is wiser (64) than the warrior.

Cook II.12.2.
The elephant is larger than the horse.

Cook II.12.3.
God created all (om. the) fishes in (om. the) sea.

Cook II.12.4.
The cattle seek fodder.

Cook II.12.5.
God commanded the earth to bring forth grass.

Cook II.12.6.
On the third day God gathered the waters that were under the heavens.

Local help for II.12.7: libbende gesceafta — "living creatures", feminine accusative plural. Use this whole phrase as given. Libbende uses the documented feminine -e participial ending; the earlier neuter libbendu would be a different agreement form.

Cook II.12.7.
Let the earth bring forth living creatures (the verb precedes).

Cook II.12.8.
God made man good (173).

Cook II.12.9.
He is (om. the) light that gives light to (ālīehtan) all things.

Cook II.12.10.
Some of them (151) were rich, and some were wise.

Cook II.12.11.
The night has many stars.

Cook II.12.12.
The light shineth in (on) darkness (plur.).

Local help for II.12.13: ðrēo hund and fīf and siextig daga — "three hundred and sixty-five days". Use this whole phrase as given. Hund is "hundred", siextig "sixty"; ðrēo counts the neuter hundred-unit, and daga is genitive plural. The phrase is composed from Cook's numeral rules, not quoted as a sentence from his reader. You are not being asked to recall a complete higher-numeral system.

Cook II.12.13.
The year has three hundred and sixty-five (78) days.

Cook II.12.14.
The carpenter has two sons.

Cook II.12.15.
The soldier has eight houses.

Cook II.12.16.
The peril was great.

13. Cumulative practice

Combining the constructions

The second task contains deliberate errors to diagnose and correct; its input is not a model of correct Old English.

X01.
Translate this connected account: The fisherman commanded the men to carry the fish (sing.). I saw them carry it. I know that they helped him. Use hātan and gesēon with plain infinitives, then an indicative factual content clause.

X02.
Repair the case relations in these intended sentences and explain each repair: (a) 'I see him carrying the fish', written Ic gesēo hē ðone fisc beran.; (b) 'God made the man good', written God geworhte ðone mann gōd. Keep the selected complements.

Sources and editorial notes

The principal editions are Albert S. Cook, *A First Book in Old English: Grammar, Reader, Notes, and Vocabulary*, second edition, revised and enlarged (Ginn, 1895), and *Exercises in Old English* (Ginn, 1895). The complete II.9–12 prompts are on *Exercises* pp. 4–6 / PDF pp. 12–14. Their wording and original grammar references are retained. The twelve examples, fisherman dialogue and lettered tasks are new teaching material.

"The Choice of Occupations" is on *First Book* p. 131 / PDF p. 147. The four selected turns occupy prose lines 7–15 counted from the top of the page, with printed marginal numbers 10 and 15 anchoring the count. Cook's words, spelling and conjectural insertions are retained. Source line breaks and superscript note cues are replaced by paragraphs and the separately printed original notes, whose numbers and anchors identify their locations. The preceding goods catalogue and price exchange are outside this excerpt.

The complement and wish constructions follow Cook §§164–165, 169, 172–173, 193–196 and 199–200, with the partitive and appositional contrast in §§151 and 154b. R. D. Fulk, *An Introductory Grammar of Old English with an Anthology of Readings*, author-corrected open-access reprint (2020), §§44–45 and 58, corroborates the mood and infinitive distinctions; his note on þrēo, p. 47, supports neuter agreement with mixed-gender groups. The preference, trade and service frames have contextual witnesses on Cook pp. 130–133.

The noun and adjective patterns use Cook pp. 27–43 and the individual vocabulary entries. The verbal systems use §§92–119 and 141, with the stem alternations in §§15–19 and 33–37. Complete tables combine these rules with the checked lexical stems; they do not claim that every cell occurs in the reading. Joseph and Elizabeth Mary Wright, *Old English Grammar*, second edition (1914), §§521–530, corroborates the weak-I forms. The selected wīsra genitive plural applies Wright §259.3, p. 130, on simplifying doubled r after another consonant.

Bosworth–Toller, *An Anglo-Saxon Dictionary* (1898), corroborates the specific forms or constructions under āstīgan (p. 55b), bycgan (p. 137a–b), gestillan (p. 446a), sęcgan (p. 855b) and absolute slēan (p. 883a); the *Supplement* (1921), hwā III (pp. 575a–b), supports dependent questions. The main dictionary's hund entry (p. 566a), together with Cook's numeral rules on pp. 46–48, supports the locally supplied 365-day expression. That expression and libbende gesceafta are constructed supports, not quotations from the reader.

Compound hyphens in dictionary citations are omitted in the ordinary displayed headwords; running source spelling, including for-ðām and swā-swā, is retained. The comparative wīsra and regular inflected cells are rule-based forms. The edition's sēceað remains in the source beside selected productive sēcað. PDF locators are one-based: the selected *First Book* scan uses printed page +16, *Exercises* +8, Wright +20 and Fulk +12; dictionary a/b locators identify printed columns.